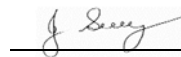


**SAFE WORK METHOD
STATEMENT**

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman: _____	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Underground Location & Potholing of Assets in a Road Reserve – TTM & Movement of Mobile Plant (Vacuum Truck)	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025 SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
John Guy Name	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd Position	0408 449 023 ☎	 Signature
			31/08/2025 – V12.0 Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Residual Risk
1.0 General Safety Requirements 	Personal injury to operator and other workers.	1	- All persons and subcontractors working on site need a current TasWater Induction Card and a Const. Industry White Card (or equivalent) - Compliance with these SWMS may be monitored via audit regimes throughout the duration of the project by Paneltec's Compliance Manager or TasWater Representative(s) - All persons who are to operate or assist with the operation of the Vacuum Truck are to be fully competent with either; <i>Operate a Drain Cleaning System</i> and <i>Vacuum Loading Certificate</i> or <i>Type 'A' Water Jetting Certificate</i> and have received information and instruction in the safe use of the machine and the potential hazards. - All Traffic Controllers on site must be accredited in: RIISS00059 - Traffic Controller Skill Set for High Volume Roads skill set (Traffic Controller) RIISS00061 – Traffic Management Implementer – High Volume Roads skill set (Traffic Management Implementer 2) In accordance with Austroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management on Temporary Traffic Management Category 2 environments. - Complete Site-Specific Risk Assessment (SSRA) prior to commencing works (Identify all Site-Specific Safety Requirements) - Conduct Tailgate Meeting during completion of SSRA discuss any pertinent site-specific hazards and lessons learnt (Eg; Asset Locations, Weather, No Go Areas etc.) - Complete and sign all relevant permits (Paneltec Excavation, Hot Work ect.) - All NDD operators must be familiar with the operator's instruction manual before using the plant - Know how to stop and start the vacuum and bleed pressure quickly. - Be familiar with controls. - Monitor NDD tank levels and weather conditions. - Do not work in an electrical storm. - The vacuum is to be operated only by trained, competent staff. - All asset locations are to be undertaken by a BYDA accredited locator.	All Compliance Manager TasWater Operators Traffic Controllers All All Supervisor All NDD Operators BYDA Locator	2

			17. All workers are to wear required PPE in accordance with TasWater & Paneltec's PIPE Policy: • Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) • Safety Boots • Hard Hat – No caps underneath • Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 • Hearing Protection (Where Required) • Gloves and Glove Clip (Razor Shield) • Face Shield in addition to Safety Glasses when cutting, grinding, using compressed air or <u>high-pressure water jetting</u>	Supervisor All	
2.0 Setting Out or taking down Roadwork Signage for Traffic Control and setting out work area 	Persons being struck by oncoming traffic or construction plant	1	1. Traffic Controllers to verify that the correct signage, control devices Traffic Management Plan (TMP) and Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) are onsite and ready for implementation. 2. Verify all Traffic Controllers have PPE in accordance with 1.17 above 3. Traffic Controller to adopt whichever control measure(s) is applicable to the site/situation as per TGS and/or TMP: • Establish/Verify the clear escape route for all traffic controllers. • All control measures, traffic control devices and signage as per the TGS • Sequence of setup to be in accordance with TGS installation sequence 4. If additional guidance to the TMP is required - refer to the Austroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management on Temporary Traffic Management Category 2 environments (<i>AGTTM</i>) and <i>AS1742.3</i> 5. If changes to the TGS are required due to operational conditions, changes may be made by an accredited traffic controller providing they are documented. 6. Due diligence must be applied when setting up traffic control as personnel are working unprotected, except for the traffic vehicle with flashing arrow board and flashing lights on. 7. Refer to the TMP and TGS for all additional site-specific set up procedures. 8. Barricade the work area, to prevent inadvertent access by public. 9. Ensure all pedestrians and cyclists have safe passage around the work site. 10. Traffic control set out vehicles to display flashing amber lights & flashing arrow board. Reverse beepers and vehicle horn must all be functional. Safety signage and traffic control devices will conform with the <i>DOS- Traffic</i>	Traffic Controllers Supervisor Traffic Controllers Traffic Controllers Traffic Controllers	2

			Control for Work on Roads-2020 guidance notes, AGTTM and AS1742.3 to ensure safety and minimise inconvenience to traffic. Traffic Guidance Scheme Number: (Please enter TGS Number)	Traffic Controllers	
3.0 Underground Asset Locating	Injuries or accidents occurring to employees/public and contact/damage with underground infrastructure	1	1. All persons engaged in the locating works are to be trained and competent in <i>RIICCM202D Identify, locate and protect underground services</i> 2. Locator to be an accredited Dial Before You Dig certified Locator and Telstra Accredited Locator. Paneltec is a CLO with DBYD. 3. Locator to ensure all DBYD enquiry sequence numbers are in the work pack prior to location and that the DBYD enquiry is within 28 Days of enquiry date 4. Locator to locate all known underground infrastructure and remain vigilant for any signs of unknown or unrecorded infrastructure. 5. Refer to Paneltec SWP-30 Opening Manholes – Safe Handling when opening manholes 6. All location works to be completed under the TGS when working within the road reserve (Refer 2.0 Above)	Supervisor Asset Locator	2
4.0 Opening manholes/pits	Manual handling Open manholes/pits	1	1. Refer to Paneltec <i>SWP-30 Opening Manholes – Safe Handling</i> 2. Install Barriers/Manhole Guard to remove Live Edge/Fall Zone	Operators	2
5.0 Electrical Hazards 	Electrocution	1	1. Conduct visual inspection for signs of underground electrical infrastructure in the project area. Visual Indicators include, but may not be limited to: • ELECTRICAL: Green electrical turrets, armored black wire (XLPE) heading underground from power poles, buried cable signs), orange conduit coming up from the ground 2. Ensure all underground electrical infrastructure has been located by consulting with the Paneltec Asset Locator 3. Conduct a visual inspection for overhead electrical infrastructure: If the distance between the vehicle/boom/cassette or operating implement and the LV (Bottom Powerlines, Wooden Pole WP) will be	Supervisor Supervisor Operator Operator Operator	2

			less than 1.0m or 3.0m (Top 22KV Powerlines, WP) reposition all equipment or introduce the control measures outlined in our SSRA/JSEA 4. Ensure a spotter is always in place when maneuvering vehicle/boom/cassette or operating implement around the overhead electrical safety envelope. 5. Ensure Paneltec's WHS 05: Emergency Procedures are available for reference in the event of an emergency. 6. All potholing around known locations of underground electrical infrastructure shall be in compliance with the requirements outlined in TasNetworks BYDA Enquiry – <i>Conditions of Work</i>.		
6.0 Operation- Vacuum Truck OPERATION OF MOBILE PLANT 	Unsafe machine potential for injury to operator or bystanders	1	1. Pre-start checks are to be completed prior to operation and are to be submitted on our WHS monitor platform. 2. All safety devices: emergency stops, reversing alarms, rotating flashing lights, communication device (radio), seat belts and fire extinguisher are effective and operational. 3. Mobile plant operators hold the appropriate licenses and competencies for the plant they are required to operate (See 1.3). 4. Mobile plant and vehicle operators always find a stationary position in a safe place prior to handling a mobile phone. 5. Safety related deficiencies are resolved before equipment is put into operation. 6. Mobile plant is always switched off and braking mechanisms are applied before being left unoccupied.	Operators Operators	2

7.0 NDD & Vacuum Potholing OPERATION OF MOBILE PLANT 	Injury to operator or bystanders – high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	1	1. Keep operating area clear of all persons. 2. Erect High Pressure Water Jetting Signs around site to be potholed 3. All workers are to wear required PPE in accordance with Paneltec PIPE Policy & TasWater Policy: - Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) - Disposable Coveralls - Safety Boots - Hard Hat – No caps underneath - Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 - Hearing Protection (Where Required) - Face Shield in addition to Safety Glasses when cutting, grinding, using compressed air or high-pressure water jetting - Gloves and Glove Clip (Razor Shield) 4. Use a spray shield next to the water jet to prevent splashes. 5. Keep operating area clear of public access 6. Stay alert and beware of the force of the water pressure coming out the end of the hose and when using the vacuum hose be aware of the suction pressure. 7. Do not overreach or stand on unstable supports. 8. Make small incision into ground/surface with hand tools or equipment 9. Place vacuum hose in a small hole. 10. Start vacuum truck. 11. Check water jetting lance connections & start jetting system. 12. Use the Lance to cut the dirt in the hole while using the vacuum truck to suck slurry out of the hole, continue to do this digging deeper until service is located. 13. Once service is located stop jetting system. 14. Remove any other slurry from the hole with vacuum truck 15. Never aim the lance in the direction of persons or animals as the water jet comes out of the nozzle at high speed with high pressure. 16. Never aim the lance on pipes presumed to contain Asbestos. 17. Do not leave the operating vacuum unattended. If the vacuum is not required switch off. 18. Follow directions as per the operations manual.	Supervisor Operators All Operators Operators Operators	2
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8.0 Housekeeping	Falling or tripping over on site resulting in strains, sprains or injury.	2	1. Maintain good housekeeping, especially hoses. 2. Frequent checks of the full length of site to be conducted 3. Ensure all rubbish is placed in the bins provided. 4. Barricade off unsafe areas with Manhole guards or Tiger Tailed barriers. 5. Clearly mark protruding objects using paint, caps, or hazard tape. 6. Ensure open pits or manholes are guarded to prevent falling in.	Supervisor Operators	3
9.0 Backfilling of Potholes (FCR)	1. Striking personnel and plant. Dust in eyes.	1	1. Use spotter when trucks entering exiting & or personnel are working near each other. Refer 5.0 above. 2. Where possible minimise fuel powered equipment & personnel in work areas. 3. Operational flashing light and reversing beeper on vehicles and equipment. 4. Suppress dust using water truck. 5. Safety glasses must be worn at all times and PPE in accordance with 1.15. 6. Compactor to be used on conjunction with the requirements outlined in <i>SWP 18 Trench compactor</i>	Supervisor All Operators	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	- Personnel have been advised at tailgate meeting of designated emergency muster point and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. - Emergency numbers are available in <i>WHS Monitor - WHS 05 Emergency Procedures</i>.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	Control exhaust emissions e.g. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	- TasWater to notify local residents in advance of works being undertaken - All complaints to be reported to TasWater Customer Service Centre	Supervisor All	3
	Irate residents and complaints	2	All complaints to be reported to TasWater Customer Service Centre	Operators	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require removal of vegetation for truck access to TasWater Network.	2	- Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat defines work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. - Approval to be sought from TasWater, prior to removal of any vegetation.	Supervisor All TasWater	3
	Transference of noxious weeds	3	Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Operators	3

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Noise Pollution	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during “normal” hours where possible. 2. Notification of works to effected residents. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers.	Supervisor All	2
Soil Management & Water Quality	Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Drivers to check vehicle tires/bodies for build up of mud	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 1. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse on-site. Artificial lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 1. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	3

List of plant for this Activity

Vacuum Truck, HDD

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Highly Visible Vests/Workwear	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Sun ring for Hard Hat (UV)	Sunglasses (Approved Safety)	Razor Shield Gloves & Clip	White reflective overalls
Hard Hat at all Times	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long Sleeves and Pants	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	Face Shield when using jetting hose

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card			
- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	- TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)
First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training	First Aid certificate training

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2012

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2021	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2018	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2018	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2018	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2018	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2018
Excavation Work - 2018	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2018	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2018	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2018	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure water Jetting 2012			

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site – HDD & Vacuum Truck
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

WORK ACTIVITY BRIEFING**Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS**

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.